

Colour Theory Applied to the Taskko Prototype

Competitor palettes · the 60-30-10 rule · colour harmonies · colour temperature

Course	Mobile Application Development (MAD) — Lab 13: Colour Theory
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App	Taskko — AI productivity, gamification & companion app for students
Tool	Adobe Color (color.adobe.com) for palette extraction & harmony rules
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1. Introduction & objectives

This lab applies colour theory to the Taskko prototype. Working from two competitor applications, we extracted their colour palettes, re-skinned the Taskko Home screen using the 60-30-10 ratio, demonstrated the five colour-harmony techniques on the prototype, and explored how colour temperature (warm / cool / neutral / achromatic) changes the feel of the app. The Home screen is used throughout as the representative prototype image because it contains the full range of UI roles — background, cards, statuses and a primary call-to-action.

Objectives addressed: (1) two competitor palettes via Adobe Color; (2) colour schemes applied with the 60-30-10 ratio; (3) the five harmonies — monochromatic, complementary, split-complementary, analogous and triadic; (4) application-type colours — warm, cool, neutral and achromatic.

2. Tool — Adobe Color (color.adobe.com)

All palettes in this report were produced with Adobe Color. Two of its modes were used:

- **Extract Theme from Image** — we uploaded a screenshot of each competitor app and let Adobe Color sample five representative swatches (its “Colorful / Muted / Deep” extraction modes), then read off the hex codes.
- **Colour-wheel harmony rules** — we set Taskko’s base hue (sky-blue, 197°) on the wheel and switched between the Monochromatic, Complementary, Split-Complementary, Analogous and Triadic rules to generate each harmony mathematically.

The 60-30-10 rule is an interior-design / UI convention: roughly 60% of the screen is a dominant (usually neutral) colour, 30% a secondary colour, and 10% a vivid accent reserved for the most important action. Every mock-up below follows it.

3. Competitor palettes

3.1 Habitica — gamified habit & to-do RPG

Habitica turns chores and study tasks into a role-playing game with health, experience and gold — the closest competitor to Taskko’s gamification layer. Its identity is strongly purple, with bright RPG stat colours (blue mana, red health, gold XP).

Pale lilac	Brand purple	Task blue	Health red	XP gold
#F3EFFB	#6133B4	#2995CD	#F74E52	#FFB445
#F3EFFB	#6133B4	#2995CD	#F74E52	#FFB445

Five-swatch palette extracted from Habitica using Adobe Color.

3.2 Forest — focus / anti-distraction timer

Forest grows a virtual tree while you stay focused — a direct competitor to Taskko’s focus-session feature. Its palette is calm and natural: green-dominant with a gold “coin” reward accent.

Pale mint	Forest green	Deep pine	Leaf	Coin gold
#EAF3EC	#3E8E5A	#1E5631	#7BC47F	#F4B400
#EAF3EC	#3E8E5A	#1E5631	#7BC47F	#F4B400

Five-swatch palette extracted from Forest using Adobe Color.

4. Applying the palettes with the 60-30-10 ratio

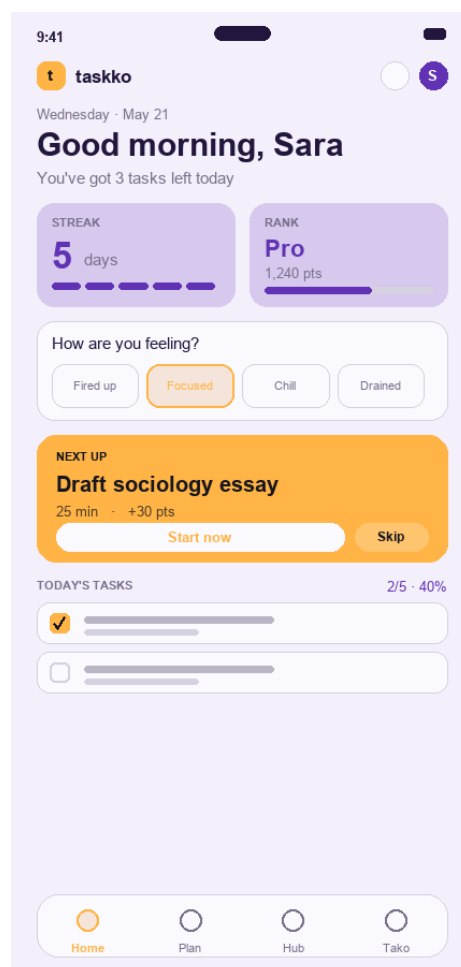
Each competitor palette was mapped onto the Taskko Home screen. The lightest tint becomes the 60% dominant background, the brand colour becomes the 30% secondary (cards, avatar, progress bars), and a vivid swatch becomes the 10% accent reserved for the “Next up” hero and the primary button.

4.1 Habitica skin

60% pale lilac background · 30% brand purple on the stat cards, avatar and progress · 10% XP-gold on the “Next up” hero and Start-now button.

60% · Dominant / background #F3E9FB	30% · Secondary #6133B4	10% · Accent #FFB445
#F3E9FB	#6133B4	#FFB445

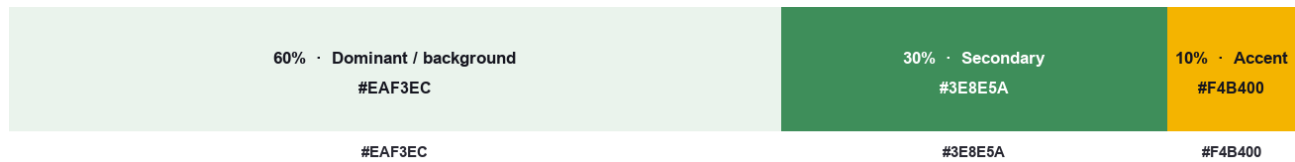
60-30-10 distribution for this skin.



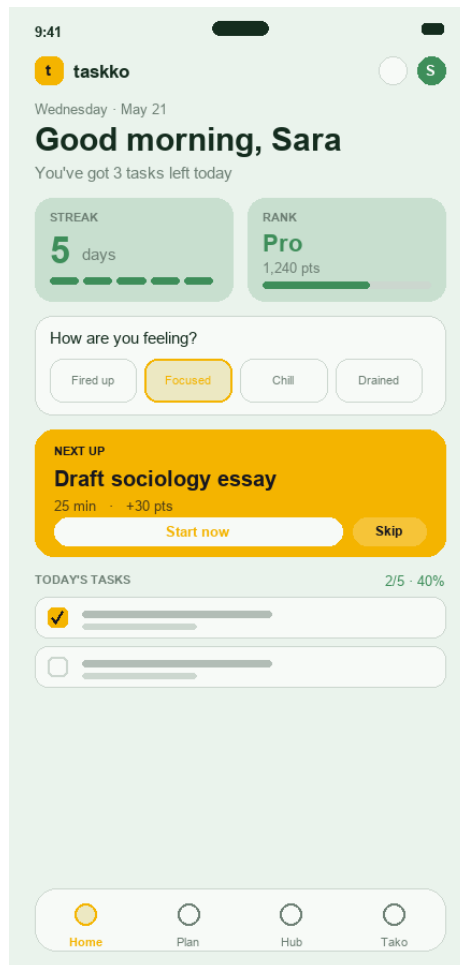
Taskko Home re-skinned in the Habitica palette.

4.2 Forest skin

60% pale mint background · 30% forest-green on the stat cards and progress · 10% coin-gold accent on the hero and primary action.



60-30-10 distribution for this skin.



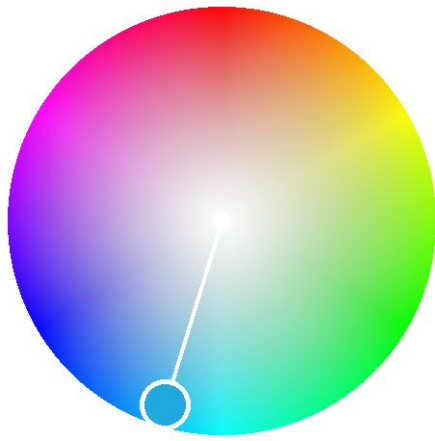
Taskko Home re-skinned in the Forest palette.

5. Colour-harmony techniques on the prototype

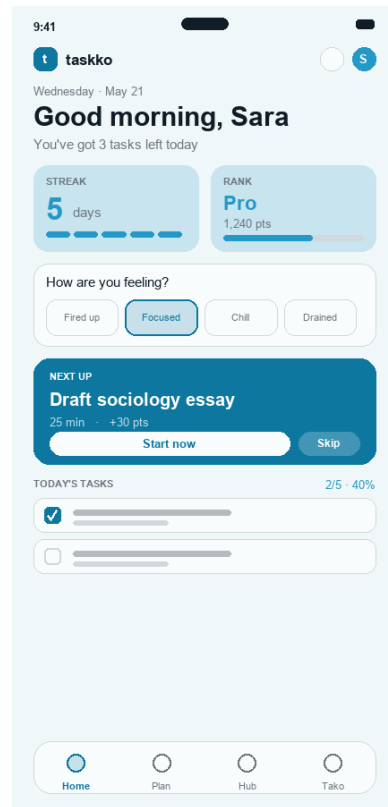
Using Taskko's base hue (sky-blue, 197°) on the Adobe Color wheel, each harmony rule produces a different set of related hues. Below, each harmony is shown as its position on the colour wheel, its palette, and the Taskko Home screen recoloured with it (still following 60-30-10).

5.1 Monochromatic — 197° only — varied tints & shades

A single hue used in many tints and shades. Result: calm, cohesive and very low visual noise. Trade-off: little contrast, so the call-to-action is carried by the darkest shade.



Harmony on the colour wheel



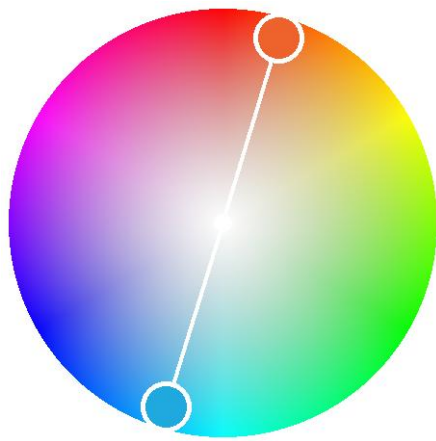
Taskko Home recoloured

Tint	Light	Base	Shade	Dark
#E4EDF1	#88C5DD	#26A6D9	#0E7EAA	#065574
#E4EDF1	#88C5DD	#26A6D9	#0E7EAA	#065574

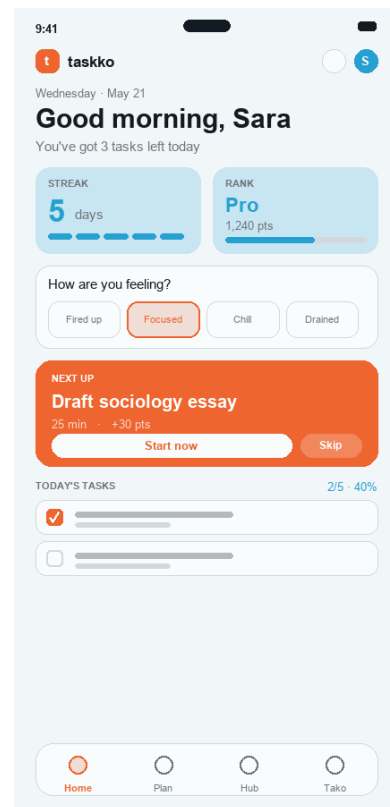
Monochromatic palette.

5.2 Complementary — 197° + 17° (opposite)

The base blue paired with its opposite, warm orange. Maximum contrast — the orange “Next up” hero pops hard against the blue UI. Excellent for a single strong CTA; used sparingly to avoid vibration.



Harmony on the colour wheel



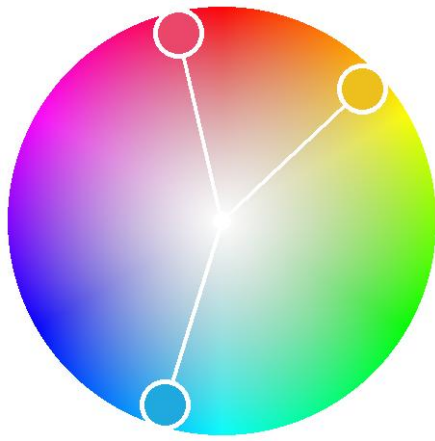
Taskko Home recoloured

Tint	Base 197°	Shade	Comp 17°	Comp tint
#EBF2F4	#25A0D0	#0D77A0	#EE652F	#EBBFAD
#EBF2F4	#25A0D0	#0D77A0	#EE652F	#EBBFAD

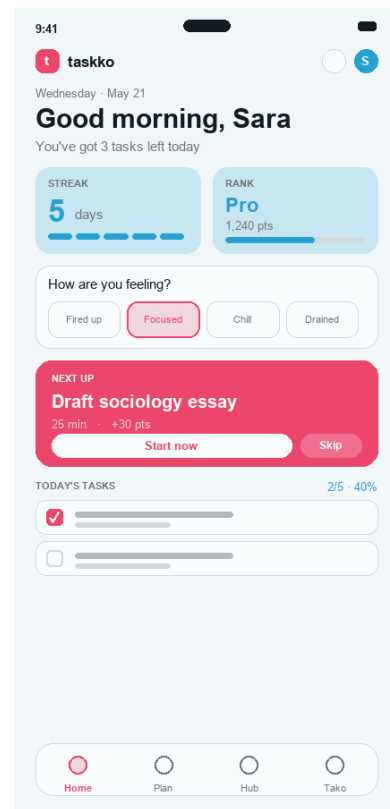
Complementary palette.

5.3 Split-Complementary — 197° + 347° + 47°

The base plus the two hues either side of its complement (rose & amber). Keeps complementary's contrast but is softer and gives two accent options — easier to balance than pure complementary.



Harmony on the colour wheel



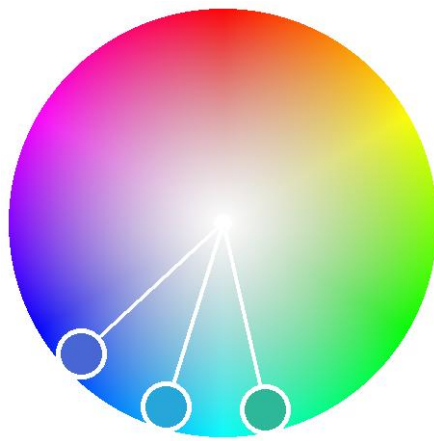
Taskko Home recoloured

Tint	Base 197°	347°	47°	Shade
#EBF2F4	#25A0D0	#EB476B	#EDC01D	#0D77A0
#EBF2F4	#25A0D0	#EB476B	#EDC01D	#0D77A0

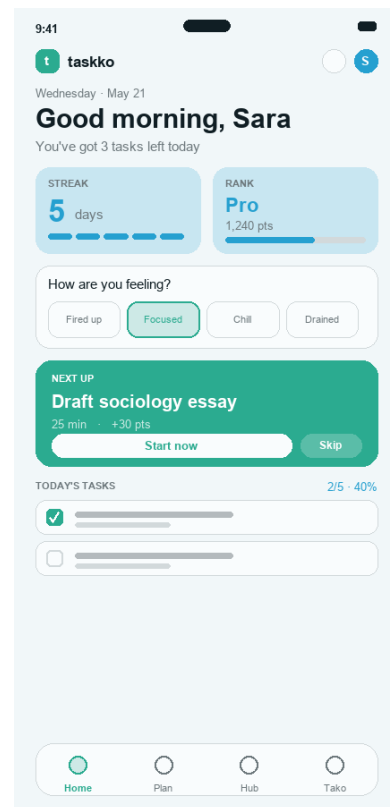
Split-Complementary palette.

5.4 Analogous — 167° + 197° + 227°

Three neighbours on the wheel (teal, blue, indigo). Very harmonious and serene — ideal for a focus app. Lower contrast, so the teal/indigo accents stay subtle and restful.



Harmony on the colour wheel



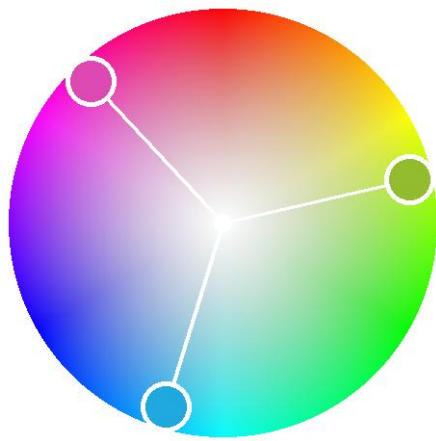
Taskko Home recoloured

167° tint	167°	197° base	227°	227° tint
#88DDCA	#2DB496	#25A0D0	#4967D4	#ABB7E3
#88DDCA	#2DB496	#25A0D0	#4967D4	#ABB7E3

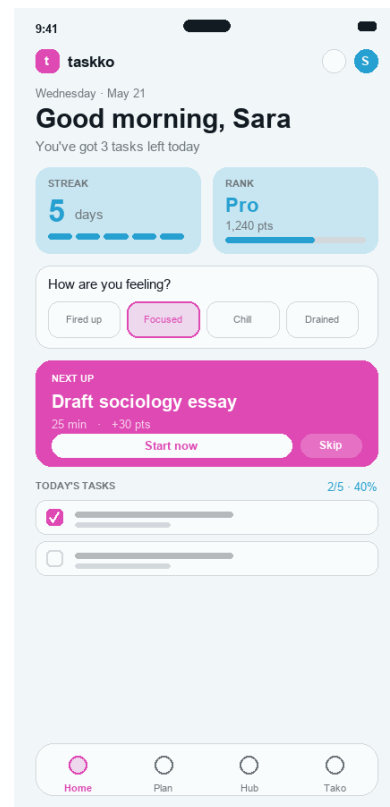
Analogous palette.

5.5 Triadic — 197° + 317° + 77°

Three evenly-spaced hues (blue, magenta, lime). Vibrant and playful — a good fit for the gamified side — but one hue (blue) must stay dominant with the other two as accents to avoid chaos.



Harmony on the colour wheel



Taskko Home recoloured

Tint	197°	317°	77°	Shade
#EBF2F4	#25A0D0	#DF49B4	#94BC2F	#0D77A0
#EBF2F4	#25A0D0	#DF49B4	#94BC2F	#0D77A0

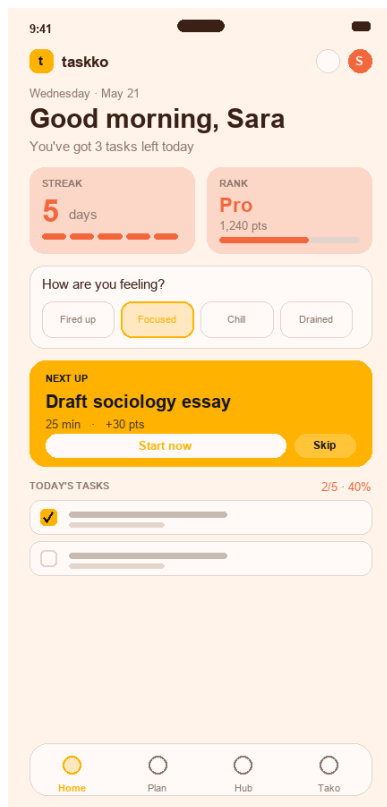
Triadic palette.

6. Application-type colours (temperature)

The same screen rendered in four colour temperatures, with the type of application each best suits.

6.1 Warm colours

Reds, oranges and yellows — energetic, urgent and motivating. Great for streaks, rewards and CTAs, but an all-warm UI can feel stressful across long study sessions. Best for food, fitness, sales and high-energy social apps.



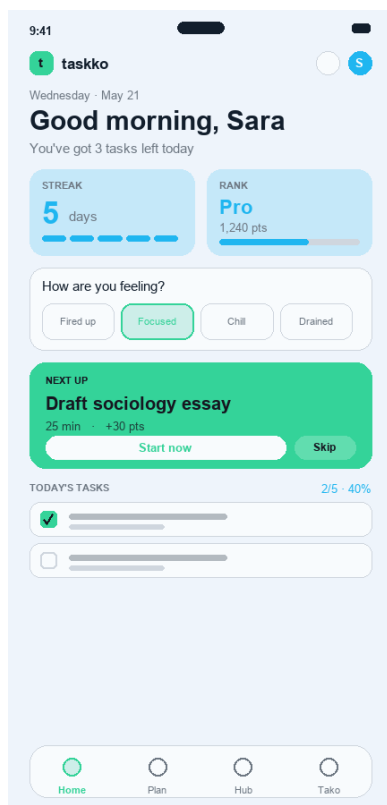
Taskko Home



Palette

6.2 Cool colours

Blues, greens and purples — calm, trustworthy and focus-promoting. The best fit for Taskko's core study/focus experience (and its real base hue). Best for productivity, finance, health and learning apps.



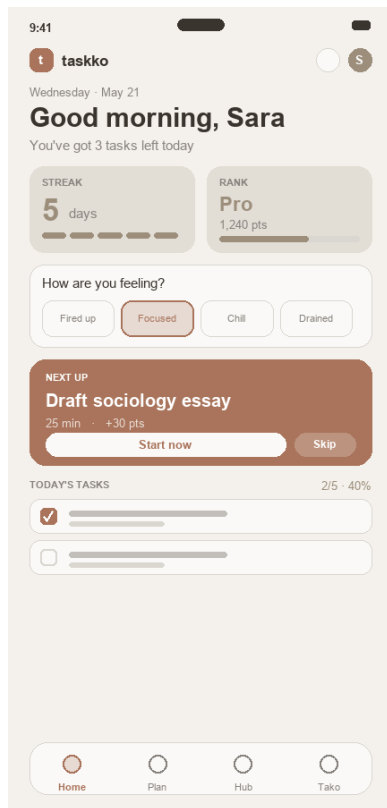
Taskko Home



Palette

6.3 Neutral colours

Beiges, taupes, sage and warm greys — minimal, mature and low-fatigue. A quiet canvas that lets content and accents stand out; can feel dull on its own. Best for reading, journaling and premium/lifestyle apps.



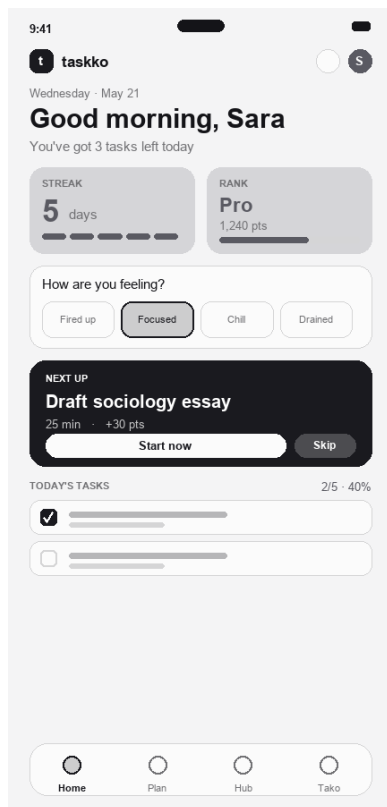
Taskko Home



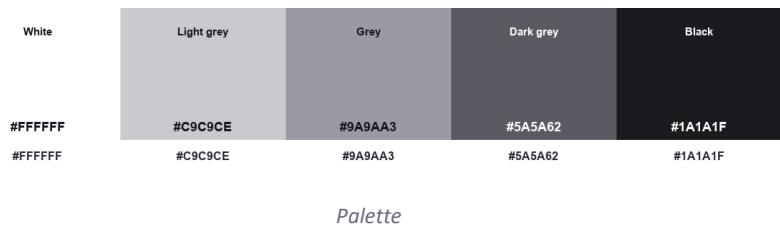
Palette

6.4 Achromatic colours

Black, white and greys only — pure tonal contrast and hierarchy. This is the accessibility / contrast baseline: if the layout reads clearly here, it works for low-vision users before any colour is added.



Taskko Home



7. Conclusion — the recommended scheme for Taskko

Taskko is simultaneously a focus app (which wants calm) and a motivation/gamification app (which wants energy). The colour exercise points to a clear recipe that balances both:

- **Cool base (60-30%):** sky-blue for a calm, trustworthy, focus-friendly core.
- **Warm accent (10%):** a peach/gold accent on the “Next up” hero, streaks and rewards for motivation — a split-complementary pairing with the blue.
- **Neutral background (the 60%):** a near-white, lightly-tinted canvas to keep long sessions low-fatigue.
- **Achromatic baseline:** the layout is designed to read in greyscale first, guaranteeing contrast and accessibility before colour is layered on.

This is exactly the cool-blue + warm-accent + neutral direction that the complementary / split-complementary harmonies produced, and it matches Taskko’s real design tokens (#1FB6F0 sky-blue, #FF8A65 peach, neutral background). The competitor study confirmed it: Forest’s calm green base and Habitica’s reward-gold accent are two halves of the same idea — a calm core with an energetic reward accent.

Interactive prototype: <https://www.figma.com/design/Xa83tCHSfbzluGEJft8zAz/Taskko-%E2%80%94App-Design>